

WARM-UP



Look at the pictures. In pairs, ask and answer the following questions.

- How can we find out what's going on in the world?
- What are your favourite kinds of TV programme? Why?
- How often do you use the internet? What do you use it for?



DEVELOP YOUR WRITING SKILLS



A

What style is it?

Different types of writing have different types of style.

Look at these extracts from different pieces of writing and write **T** for True or **F** for False next to the statements below each extract.

A Don't know what to do with yourself during the holidays? Why not think about making a short film? It's actually not that difficult, it's very creative and it's great fun! All you really need is a video camera.

- 1 The style is conversational and chatty. _____
- 2 The writer wants the reader to reply to the questions. _____
- 3 The writer uses contractions. _____
- 4 This is probably an extract from a letter. _____

B Many people argue that reading is an active pastime, whereas watching television is essentially passive. This, in my opinion, is a rather simplistic point of view.

- 1 The style is conversational and chatty. _____
- 2 The writer uses formal grammar and vocabulary. _____
- 3 The writer uses discursive words and phrases. _____
- 4 This is probably an extract from a composition for a teacher. _____

C Oh, by the way, have you got the latest issue of 'TeenPop' yet?
It's great! There's a really cool interview with The Backroad Boys.
Joey looks as cute as ever!

- 1 The style is very conversational and chatty.
- 2 The writer uses formal grammar and vocabulary.
- 3 The writer uses some informal punctuation.
- 4 This is probably an extract from a letter.

D She casually opened the newspaper.
There, on page two, was a large photograph of Colin. 'Oh no!' she thought to herself. What's he done this time?' She sighed as she read the report below the picture.

- 1 The writer uses descriptive language.
- 2 Most of the verbs are in the simple past.
- 3 The direct speech is as formal as the rest of the extract.
- 4 This is probably an extract from a short story.

E KiTV currently has no game shows or quiz shows which are aimed specifically at teenagers. The research which has been carried out indicates that there may be a market for such programmes.

- 1 The style is conversational and chatty.
- 2 The writer uses informal grammar and vocabulary.
- 3 The writer uses the passive.
- 4 This is probably an extract from an article for a magazine for teenagers.

F I would be very grateful if you could let me know what time we should arrive at the studio, and how long the recording is expected to take.

- 1 The style is conversational and chatty.
- 2 The writer wants the reader to answer the questions.
- 3 The writer uses formal grammar and vocabulary.
- 4 This is probably an extract from a report.

B What text type is it?

Now match each of the extracts **A-F** above with one of the text types below.

- 1 a report
- 2 a formal letter
- 3 a letter to your cousin
- 4 a short story
- 5 an article for a magazine for teenagers
- 6 a composition for your teacher

DEVELOP YOUR WRITING SKILLS

C

Study the models

Look at model compositions 1-8 on pages 100-103.

Find examples from the compositions and write them in the chart below.

model 1	find an example of a chatty, conversational style	
model 2	find an example of a rhetorical question	
model 3	find an example of a phrase where part or all of the verb is missing	
model 4	find an example of formal vocabulary	
model 5	find an example of direct speech	
model 6	find an example of indirect speech	
model 7	find an example of an indirect question	
model 8	find an example of a sentence beginning with 'But' and a sentence beginning with 'And'.	

D

Change the style

Here are some more extracts from different pieces of writing. Unfortunately, the writers haven't been very successful with their style. Rewrite the extracts in your notebook in a more appropriate style.

1 from a letter to a friend

I would like to inform you that my parents have finally given me permission to attend the recording of your appearance on 'Who Wants to be a Teenage Millionaire'. I look forward to it very much. I would be very grateful if you could let me know what time I should arrive at the studio.

2 from a report

So, I did what you told me and looked at lots of different mags for teenagers – most of them are rubbish. They're mainly about pop and looking cool. I guess they think teenagers aren't into anything more serious. Idiots! Anyway, here's what I found out.

3 from an article for a young people's magazine

The majority of young people today use the internet on a regular basis. However, few of them consider creating their own website. This is unfortunate. In my opinion, they need to realise that website creation is relatively straightforward. Moreover, it is both enjoyable and constructive.

E

Read your partner's writing



Look at how your partner has rewritten the extracts above.

Do you think they have a more appropriate style now?

Can you make any suggestions to improve them further?

COMPOSITION DEVELOPMENT



Read this composition question and do the exercises that follow.

You have seen this announcement in an international student magazine:

Does TV just entertain us, or is it informative too?

We are looking for articles on this subject. Write and tell us what you think.

Write your **article**.

A

What am I writing?

Write **T** for True and **F** for False next to these statements.

- 1 I should start by writing 'Dear Sir/Madam,'. _____
- 2 My article should be very formal. _____
- 3 My article should sound academic. _____
- 4 Most of the readers will be professors and editors. _____
- 5 I should try to interest the readers. _____
- 6 I can write in a conversational style. _____
- 7 I can ask the readers rhetorical questions. _____
- 8 I can use contractions if I wish. _____
- 9 I should use very simple and informal vocabulary. _____
- 10 I should write about four paragraphs. _____

B

Brainstorming

Make notes to answer these questions. Then discuss your answers with the class.

- 1 What kind of TV programmes entertain? _____
- 2 How do they entertain people? _____
- 2 Give an example: _____
- 3 What kind of TV programmes are informative? _____
- 4 What do they inform us about? _____
- 5 Give an example: _____
- 6 Can you think of any programmes that are informative and entertaining at the same time? _____
- 7 What's your opinion? Is most TV entertaining? _____
Is most TV informative? _____
Can it be both at the same time? _____

C

Think about style

Which of these might be a good beginning for your article? Circle the letters of the beginnings you think are appropriate.

- a TV's really cool, right? Yeah, course it is.
- b Have you ever wondered why television is so popular?
- c I strongly believe that students should not have time to watch television.
- d Television has both advantages and disadvantages.
- e What I like most about television is the choice of programmes available.

D

Think about paragraphing

Your article will probably have four paragraphs. Match a paragraph purpose on the right with each paragraph 1-4.

- 1 a explore the issue of TV as entertainment
- 2 b introduce the topic, get the reader interested
- 3 c bring your ideas together, express your general opinion
- 4 d explore the issue of TV as informative



E

Plan your paragraphs

Complete the following paragraph plan for your letter, making notes on what you are going to include in each paragraph.

Article plan	
Title	
Paragraph 1	
Paragraph 2	
Paragraph 3	
Paragraph 4	

F

Homework

Now write your article. Read this checklist. When you have written your article, tick the boxes.

- ☐ I have written an article, not a letter.
- ☐ I have tried to interest the reader.
- ☐ I have used a conversational style.
- ☐ I have used at least one rhetorical question.
- ☐ I have written at least four paragraphs.
- ☐ I have checked my article carefully for mistakes.



Read these sentences and then use the words in bold to complete the sentences below.

- I don't like **tabloid** newspapers because they're full of gossip and scandal. I prefer more serious papers.
- I've taken out a monthly **subscription** to *Teenpop* magazine. They send it to me every month through the post.
- There was a very interesting **documentary** on last night about the South American rainforests.
- I love *Friends*. It's so funny! It's the best **sitcom/situation comedy** on TV.
- And you can watch the next **episode** of *Friends* at the same time tomorrow night.
- I've seen this episode before. It must be a **repeat**.
- What's the **address** of your website? I'd love to check it out.
- She writes a weekly **column** for the local newspaper. She's always giving her opinion about something or other.
- There are two main kinds of book: hardbacks and **paperbacks**.
- I don't have very good **reception** where I live, so I can't pick up all the TV channels very clearly.

- 1 Have you seen that new _____ with Tony Parker? It's set in a shoe shop and it's hilarious!
- 2 The _____ is www.my-autographs.gr.
- 3 I don't know why you get that _____ every day. There's never any news in it.
- 4 I mustn't forget to set the video to record the next _____ of *Melrose Place*.
- 5 I'll take a couple of _____ to read by the pool.
- 6 The _____ is terrible. Are you sure you've tuned in the TV properly?
- 7 There's a _____ about space travel on BBC1, and a black and white movie on BBC2.
- 8 I think I'll cancel my _____ to Forthlink; other companies are offering much cheaper internet connection packages these days.
- 9 So what if it's a _____! Don't you want to see it again?
- 10 I always read Martin Flannigan's _____ in *The Post*. He's very clever.

EXAM PRACTICE — ARTICLE

Exam know-how

- When you are writing an article, don't start writing immediately. Think about the question first and note down some ideas. Then make a paragraph plan. Only write the article when you know exactly what you want to say, in which paragraph you want to say it and how you want to express it.

Each of these articles should be written in **120-180** words in an appropriate style.

- 1 Your favourite magazine is running a writing competition this month. The prize is a tour round a television studio. To enter the competition, you have to write an article describing your favourite television programme and explaining why you would recommend it to others.

Write your **article**.

- 2 Your school magazine is running a series of articles under the title 'Radio and Young People.' You have been asked to write an article to appear in the series giving your views on how popular radio is with young people today.

Write your **article**.

Grammar focus

KiTV currently has no game shows or quiz shows **which are aimed** specifically at teenagers.

Another way of writing the same thing is:

KiTV currently has no game shows or quiz shows **aimed** specifically at teenagers.

The person marking your compositions will be impressed if you use this piece of grammar in your writing!

Rewrite these sentences without the relative pronoun and the auxiliary verb.

- 1 It's a problem page which has been specifically designed for teenagers and young adults.

- 2 The internet doesn't have many websites which have been created by young people.

- 3 I was interviewed by a reporter who was called Ivor Penn!

- 4 Books which are printed with soft covers are called paperbacks.

- 5 She's a journalist who is well known for her rudeness to politicians.
